

SEARCH FOR TODO AND DELETE

Switching from Sphinx to Markdown

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reStructuredText (reST) and Sphinx

- What is it?
- History
- Documentation generation
- Ecosystem inertia



Markdown

- What is it?
- History
- Adoption
- AI integration
- Documentation options



Pros and cons of reST

- What it does well
- Difficulties it presents



Pros and cons of Markdown

- What it does well
- Difficulties it presents



Which one is better?

It depends.



Migrating BeeWare: How it began

"Once upon a time, reST seemed like a good idea, but I'm increasingly thinking moving to Markdown across the board would be worth it."

"If only we had a sprint coming up..."



Migrating BeeWare: The full scope

- Four categories:
 - Tutorial
 - Major tools: Toga, Briefcase, Rubicon Obj-C
 - Standalone documents
 - Website



Website content

- Lektor in reST mode
- Pandoc and Lektor API
- Proof of reST to Markdown

A few hours...



Preparation for project migration

- Consider options
- Investigate MkDocs
- Translations
- Explore add-ons
- Migration automation
- Tools

One and a half months...



Preparation: Consider options

- Requirements
- Sphinx and MyST parser
- MkDocs
- Other alternatives



Preparation: Investigate MkDocs

- Learn the basics
- Research features
- Material theme
- Establish viability



Preparation: Build and translations

- No viable translation options
- Translate Toolkit
- Build integration
- Build tooling



Preparation: Explore add-ons

- `attr_list`
- `mkdocs-autorefs`
- `mkdocs-macros`
- `mkdocs-literate-nav`
- `mkdocstrings`
- PyMDown Extensions



Preparation: PyMDown Extensions

- *Highlight* - code syntax highlighting
- *Caption* - image captions
- *Admonition* - display admonitions
- *Details* - collapsible content
- *Tab* - tabbed content
- *Snippets* - external content injection



Preparation: Customise Pandoc

- Pandoc Markdown extensions
- CommonMark vs CommonMarkX
- Tailoring the Pandoc command

```
find -f **/*.rst -type f -exec sh -c pandoc -f rst "${0}"  
    -t commonmark_x-bracketed_spans-smart-alerts  
    -o "$(dirname {})/$(basename {} .rst).md" {} \;
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Preparation: Conversion scripts

- Content
- Docstrings
- Translations

```
r"((#*)?( )?`(~)?([A-Za-z0-9\n. \- _! '\"]*)(?:\\(\\))?(?:<)?(?:\\/)?([.a-z0-9\\/\-]*)?>?`{.interpreted-text(?:\n)?(?: )?role=\"([a-z]+)\"})"
```



Preparation: Linting and checks

- rumdl
- PySpelling
- markdown-checker



Preparation: BeeWare Docs Tools

- Sandbox for feature testing
- Single source of dependencies
- Theme unification
- Shared content
- Build tooling



Tutorial

- Good first project
- Relevant basic features
- Translated content

Two weeks...



Toga

- Most complex project
- Proof of concept
- Configuration
- Additional changes
- Manual verification

Two and a half months...



Briefcase

- Less complicated
- Utilised existing tooling

Three days...



Rubicon Objective-C

- New problems to solve
- Used lessons learned

Two weeks...



Website

- Stretched the capabilities
- Simplified content creation
- Unified tooling

Three months...



Standalone documents

- Change note system
- Templates
- READMEs



The human element

- Presenting a successful proposal
- Stages
- Engaging the community



Total time:

Nine+ months



Was it worth it?

Absolutely.



Would we do it again?

Unequivocally: Yes.



Should you do it?

You decide.



Thank you!

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